



Teaching Foundational Skills in Naturally Occurring Settings

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NATIONAL COORDINATING CENTER

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Role of a College Student

Beyond Academics

- Posture
- Confidence
- Maturation
- Self-reflection



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What are we talking about???

*"There is obviously a lot of **fuzziness** in the borders between cognitive and non-cognitive, and between skills, attitudes, and dispositions. Then there is the **personality vs. process** (trait vs. state) distinction that fits in there somewhere. On top of all that there are arguments about **terminology** in which it is sometimes difficult to figure out whether the dispute is over measurement methods or constructs per se."*

- Patrick Kyllonen (2009)

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Different Disciplines



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What we were looking for.....



- Not designed for special education or disability
- Foundational skills for ALL students
- Resource that **STUDENTS** could use for self-reflection (assistance as needed)
- No materials that might be used to screen out students who did not meet criteria

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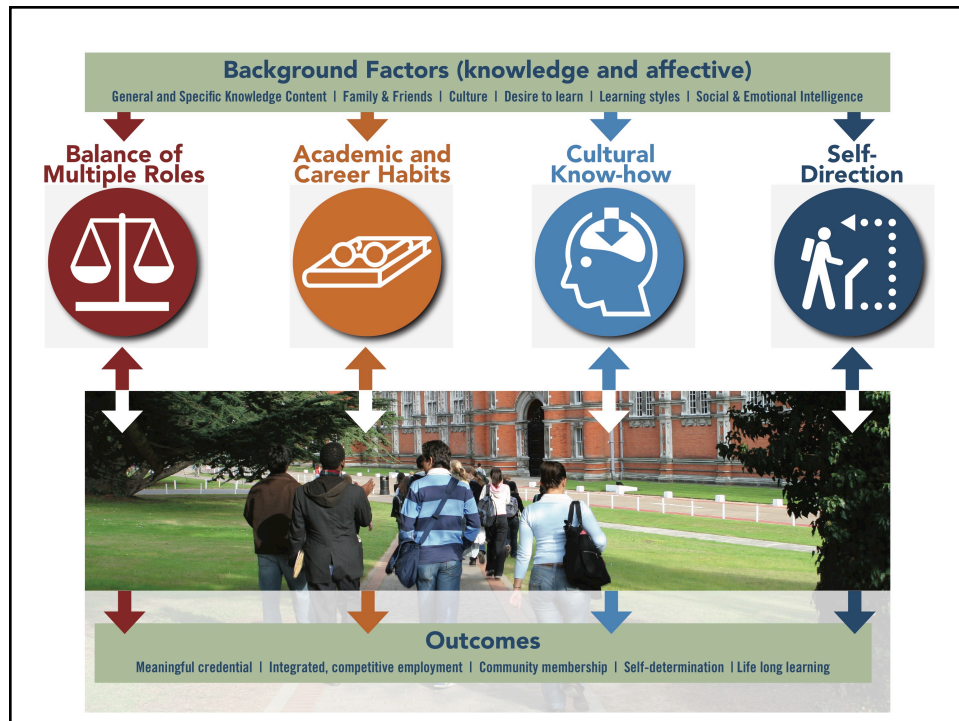
Existing Resources

- Common Core College & Career Readiness
- Soft Skills to Pay the Bills (ODEP)
- Habits of Mind
- First Year Experience
- Self Determination
- Work Based Learning
- Social & Emotional Learning
- Personal Competencies for College & Career Success (NCWDY)
- Karp & Bork materials



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Foundational Skills & Characteristics

Cultural Know-how

	Skill	Characteristics
	Commitment	Attends class, job, and campus activities Follows through on assigned tasks to completion
	Respect	Adheres to context-specific rules and expectations Demonstrates respect (as defined by culture/community) Manages conflict appropriately

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Foundational Skills & Characteristics

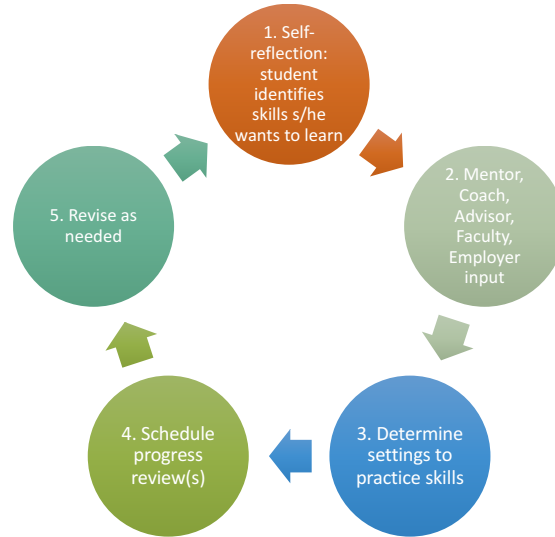
Academic and Career Habits

	Skill	Characteristics
	Attendance and punctuality	Maintains current course and work schedules Gets to class and work on time
	Use of resources	Is aware of college supports (e.g., counseling, career, library) Uses tutoring, coaching, mentoring, disability services as needed
	Communication	Communicates clearly and can make others understand their meaning Checks for understanding such as asking clarifying questions Communicates w/ college faculty, supervisors, co-workers, residence hall staff

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Foundational Skills College & Career Learning Plan Process



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Foundational Skills College & Career Learning Plan Example



SECTION 2: SPECIFIC COLLEGE AND CAREER SKILLS GOAL SETTING

Instructions: Choose the specific College and Career Skills that you want to focus on this semester, concentrating on skill areas that relate to your specific course of study and academic or career goals. With the help of a coach, mentor or supervisor, list those skills and identify how you will learn the characteristics associated with this skill. You may want to explain where you will learn this skill at either the college or in the workplace.

Specific College or Career Skills	How and where you will learn this skill
Skill #1	
Skill #2	

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Next Steps



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Piloting

- Northern Kentucky University
- Millersville University
- Syracuse University
- Portland State University

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Student Experiences

- Students enjoyed self-monitoring, were proud to report success
- Peer mentors reported increased independence
- Monitoring in many formats – checklists, notes, texts, self evaluation scales
- “This tool makes you be more creative to think about ways to learn these skills in natural occurring environments.”
- “The tool allowed the students to be introspective in their first semester of college. Instead of assessments being used to set goals for students (as in K-12), they assessed themselves.”

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Field Testing

- Secure funding to conduct study
- Develop online tool
- Pilot & data collection on effectiveness of tool
- Ongoing improvement
- Large scale dissemination

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Questions

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